

**PRE-SOLICITATION NON-COMPETITIVE –
Notice of Intent to Sole Source**

1. **SOLICITATION NUMBER:** PCA-NIMH-01868
2. **TITLE:** Service Contract Renewal for Bruker Biospec 7T MRI Scanner
3. **RESPONSE DATE:** April 20, 2026, at 1:00 pm EDT.
4. **PRIMARY POINT OF CONTACT:**
Nicholas Capobianco
Nicholas.capobianco@nih.gov

I. INTRODUCTION:

THIS IS A PRE-SOLICITATION NON-COMPETITIVE (NOTICE OF INTENT) SYNOPSIS TO AWARD A CONTRACT WITHOUT PROVIDING FOR FULL OR OPEN COMPETITION (INCLUDING BRAND-NAME).

The Neurophysiology Imaging Facility (NIF), supported by NIMH, NINDS, and NEI, requires a service contract for hardware and software maintenance of its Bruker Biospec 7T MRI Scanner. This system is essential for imaging laboratory animals and must operate reliably to support ongoing research. The contract will ensure the scanner remains in optimal working condition, minimizing downtime and maintaining the high-quality imaging needed for advanced neurophysiological studies.

II. NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION SYSTEM (NAICS) CODE and SET ASIDE STATUS

NAICS code 811210- Electronic and Precision Equipment Repair and Maintenance with a business size standard classification of \$34 M. This acquisition is NOT set aside for small businesses.

III. REGULATORY AUTHORITY

The resultant contract will include all applicable provisions and clauses in effect through the Federal Acquisition Circular (FAC) 2024-07 dated 08-29-2024.

This acquisition is conducted under the procedures as prescribed in FAR subpart 13.5—Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items and FAR subpart 12—Acquisition of Commercial Items at an amount exceeding the SAT, and not exceeding \$7 million.

IV. STATUTORY AUTHORITY

This acquisition is for a commercial item or service and is conducted under the authority of the FAR Subpart 13.5—Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items and the statutory authority of [specify the applicable authority: (1) FAR 6.302-1—Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements 41 U.S.C. 3304 (a)(1).

V. DESCRIPTION OF REQUIREMENT:

A. PURPOSE AND OBJECTIVES:

B. Equipment Coverage:

This service contract applies to the NIF's 7T Bruker Biospec MRI (System ID: 5077339). The following components are excluded from coverage: RRI gradient/shim coil, PCI gradient amplifier, and non-Bruker RF coils.

C. Console Support:

The contractor shall provide full coverage for all consoles associated with the equipment listed above. In the event of an operational interruption, every effort shall be made to minimize downtime.

D. Technical Support:

The contractor shall provide email and telephone support during standard business hours.

E. Parts Inventory and Shipping:

The contractor shall maintain an inventory of parts for timely service. If the console becomes non-operational, replacement parts shall be shipped via overnight carrier at the contractor's expense. Once repairs are completed, defective components shall be returned to the contractor at their expense.

F. Replacement Parts and Warranty:

Required replacement parts shall be supplied without delay, on an exchange (refurbished) or new basis. All replacement parts shall carry a one-year warranty from the date of installation. Additional materials needed for approved engineering updates or modifications shall be provided as necessary.

G. Software Updates and Issue Resolution:

As Bruker releases new software versions for licensed applications, the contractor shall provide these updates within 30 days of the release. Any software defects or operational issues shall be addressed and corrected as soon as possible through clear and ongoing communication regarding the repair plan and progress.

H. Documentation:

The contractor shall provide complete operator manuals and technical documentation for all covered hardware and software.

LEVEL OF EFFORT:

Labor category: Service Engineer

Estimated number of labor hours for each period of performance: N/A

Contractor shall have access to proprietary parts and test instrumentation for effective repair in case of malfunction. Technical performance requirements include system coverage on the subject equipment by a certified, manufacturer trained service engineer and providers of any required parts.

GOVERNMENT RESPONSIBILITIES

The Government shall grant Contractor personnel reasonable access to the equipment as required for service and repair activities. The Government will cooperate with Contractor personnel to ensure that services are performed efficiently and without unnecessary interruption. Contractor personnel shall have access to Government facilities and equipment deemed necessary to perform the Services.

The Government shall not be responsible for any federal, state, or local taxes assessed on or measured by the Contractor's net income. Taxes applicable to the services provided shall be invoiced unless the Contractor furnishes a valid tax exemption certificate acceptable to the relevant taxing authorities.

DELIVERY OR DELIVERABLES

Contractor service technicians must be cleared at the NIH commercial vehicle inspection station located at 9000 Rockville Pike, Bethesda, MD, to gain access to the premises. Services shall be performed at Building 49 Room B2-102.

REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

Upon completion of each annual preventive maintenance visit or any repair or service visit, the Contractor shall prepare and submit a written service report to the Government via email in PDF format or as an original paper hardcopy. The report shall include a summary of the services performed, identification of all hardware and software components inspected, a description of any adjustments, repairs, or

corrections made to restore the equipment to specification, and recommendations for maintaining the equipment within optimal operating parameters. The Contractor shall provide the completed report to the Government representative prior to departing the facility or, if not practicable, within twenty-four (24) hours after completion of the service.

I. PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE:

Base Year: **12 months from Date of Award**

Include **three (3) 12-month option years**, each priced separately

VI. CONTRACTING WITHOUT PROVIDING FOR FULL OR OPEN COMPETITION (INCLUDING BRAND-NAME) DETERMINATION

The determination by the Government to award a contract without providing for full and open competition is based upon the market research conducted. Specifically, Interaxon Inc. is the only vendor in the marketplace that can provide the services required by NIMH. The equipment is proprietary to its manufacturer, Interaxon Inc, and this company is the sole provider of maintenance for this equipment.

In accordance with FAR part 10, extensive market research was conducted to reach this determination. Additionally, contacts with knowledgeable individuals both in industry and Government, as well as reviews of available product literature, revealed no other sources. Finally, a review of the GSA Advantage, Dynamic Small Business Search, and previous government acquisitions returned no results that meet all of the requirements. Therefore, only Interaxon Inc is capable of meeting the needs of this requirement.

The intended source is:

Bruker Biospin Corporation

15 Fortune Drive

Billerica MA 01821

VII. CLOSING STATEMENT

THIS SYNOPSIS IS NOT A REQUEST FOR COMPETITIVE PROPOSALS. However, interested parties may identify their interest and capability to respond to this notice.

A determination by the Government not to compete this proposed contract based upon responses to this notice is solely within the discretion of the Government. All responsible sources may submit a capability statement, proposal, or quotation which shall be considered by the agency. The information received will normally be considered solely for the purposes of determining whether to proceed on a non-competitive basis or to conduct a competitive procurement.

This notice does not obligate the Government to award a contract or otherwise pay for the information provided in response.

Responses to this notice shall contain sufficient information to establish the interested parties' bona-fide capabilities for fulfilling the requirement and include: unit price, list price, shipping and handling costs, the delivery period after contract award, the prompt payment discount terms, the F.O.B. Point (Destination or Origin), the Dun & Bradstreet Number (DUNS), the Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN), and the certification of business size. All offerors must have an active registration in the System for Award Management (SAM) www.sam.gov.

All responses must be received by the closing date and time of this announcement and must reference the solicitation number, **PCA-NIMH-01868**. Responses must be submitted electronically to Nicholas Capobianco, Contract Specialist at Nicholas.capobianco@nih.gov.